2. Incident Classification

Incident classification means identifying and labeling a security incident based on its type, impact, and attack technique.

It helps SOC analysts:

- Understand what type of attack occurred
- Decide priority level
- Respond faster
- Maintain proper documentation

1. Incident Categories

Security incidents are classified into types such as:

1. Malware
2. Phishing
3. DDoS
4. Brute Force
5. Insider Threat
6. Data Exfiltration
7. Privilege Escalation

Example:

If multiple failed login attempts are detected the it is classified as Brute Force Attack.

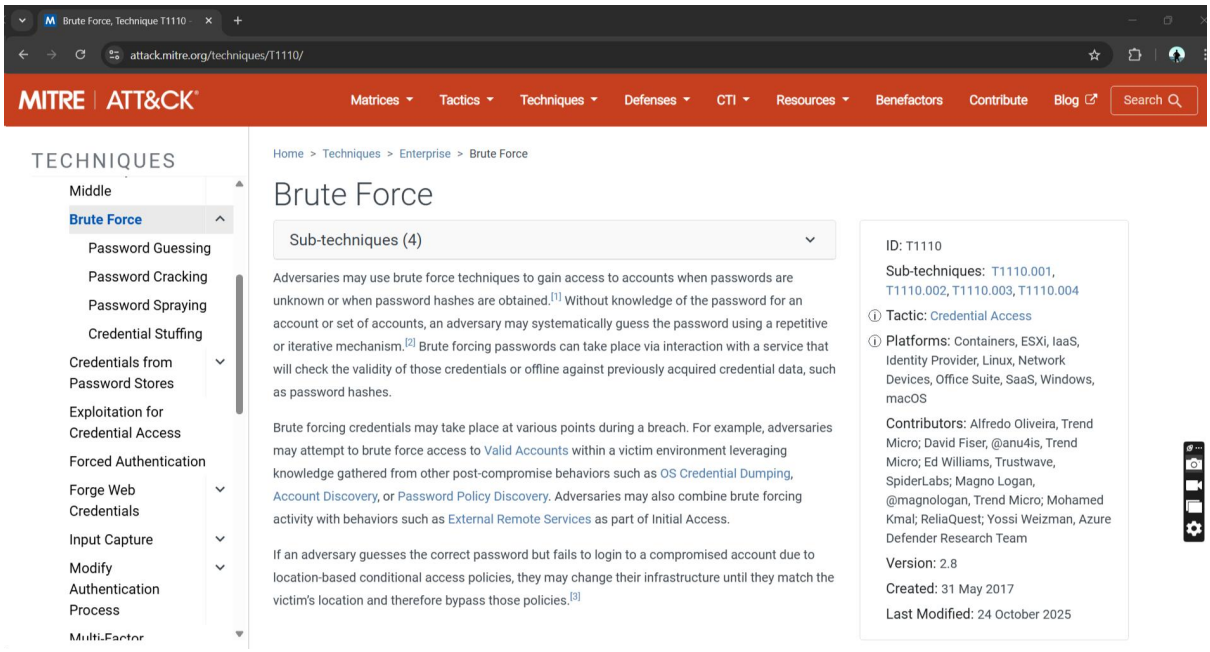
2. Taxonomy Frameworks

SOC teams use standard frameworks to classify incidents properly.

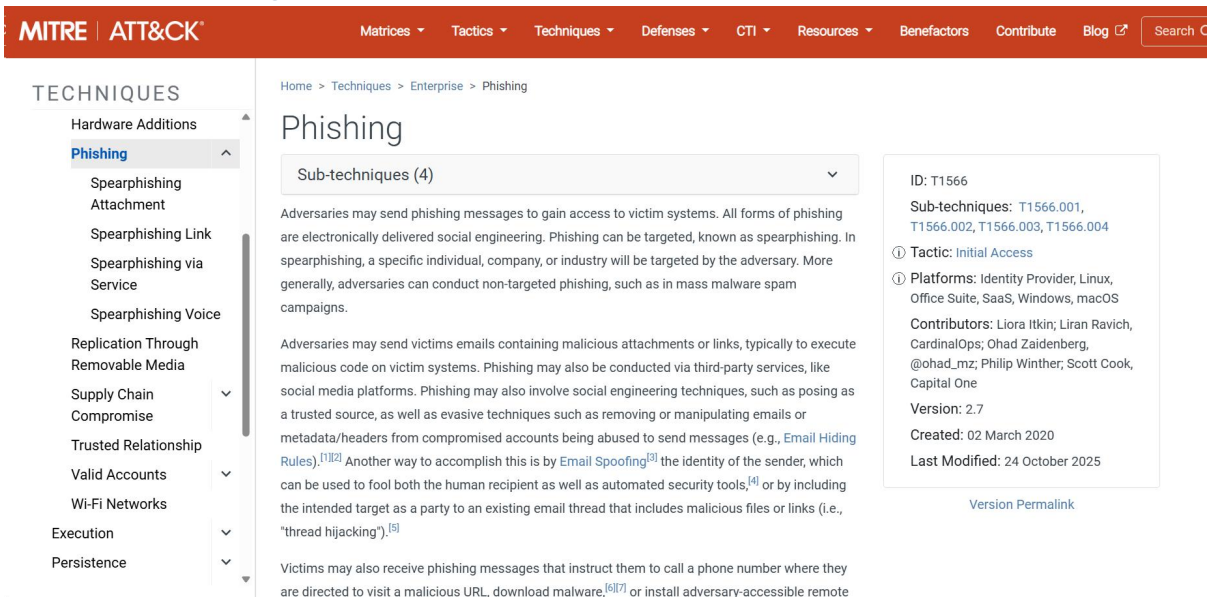
MITRE ATT&CK . Maps attack techniques to tactics.

Example:

T1110 - Brute Force



T1566 - Phishing



ENISA Incident Taxonomy

Provides structured classification model - VERIS Framework

Used for recording and sharing incident details.

3. Contextual Metadata

Every incident must include supporting details:

1. Timestamp

2. Source IP
3. Username
4. Affected system
5. Event ID
6. Impact

Example:

- Source IP: 192.168.1.50
- Event ID: 4625
- Technique: T1110
- Practical Example (Your SSH Failed Login Case)
- Incident Type: SSH Brute Force
- MITRE Technique: T1110
- Tactic: Credential Access
- Affected Asset: Test VM
- Severity: Medium
- Status: Closed

The detected activity was classified as a Brute Force attack due to multiple failed SSH login attempts within a short time period. Based on the MITRE ATT&CK framework, the activity aligns with technique T1110 (Credential Access – Brute Force). Since no successful authentication was observed, the incident was categorized as Medium severity and closed after investigation.